

LeapTalent Level 3 End-point Assessment

Learner Guide

The Streaming Wars — what to do, why, and where you are in the process |

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This guide shows one sound way to complete the scenario, the reasoning behind each step, and which stage of the data analysis process each step belongs to. This scenario is about applying the right Excel function correctly at each step. Work the task yourself first, then check your method and results here. Screenshots are illustrative mock-ups.

The data analysis process — follow it in order:

Identify → Collect → Clean/Prepare → Analyse → Visualise → Interpret/Report

Each step is tagged with its stage. Here the Analyse stage is the largest, as the scenario centres on applying a toolkit of Excel functions.

Scenario 1 — Data Gathering and Validation

Step 1 — Identify and import

STAGE 1 · IDENTIFY & 2 · COLLECT

What you do: Import both CSVs, rename the sheets **Profiles** and **Stats**, and save as **Streaming_Wars_Report.xlsx**. Confirm the two link on **UserID**.

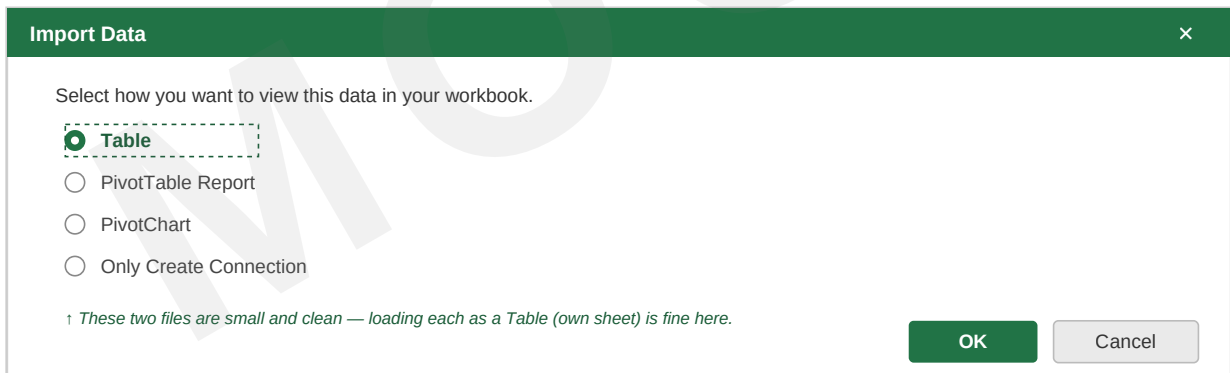


Figure 1 — These two files are small and clean, so loading each as a Table on its own sheet is appropriate.

Why load as tables here? Unlike the larger, messier scenarios, these files are small and clean and both are needed as working sheets, so loading each as a Table is sensible. Naming the sheets clearly (Profiles / Stats) makes every later formula readable.

Step 2 — Validate

STAGE 3 · CLEAN / PREPARE

What you do: Check both sheets for consistent headers, confirm UserID is unique in Profiles, and look for any missing values before blending.

Why validate first? A blend is only as reliable as its key — a duplicate or missing UserID would pull the wrong profile onto a viewing record. A quick check now prevents silent errors later.

Step 3 — Blend with XLOOKUP

STAGE 3 · CLEAN / PREPARE

What you do: In Stats, add Gender and AgeGroup columns and fill them with XLOOKUP against Profiles, matched on UserID:

```
=XLOOKUP([@UserID], Profiles[UserID], Profiles[Gender])
```

F2	fx	=XLOOKUP([@UserID], Profiles[UserID], Profiles[Gender])				
UserID	Platform	Hours	Satisf.	Cost	Gender	AgeGroup
1001	Netflix	18	8	10.99	Female	36–45
1002	Disney+	22	6	7.99	Female	26–35

*XLOOKUP pulls Gender (and AgeGroup) from the Profiles sheet, matched on UserID — blending the two tables.
Unlike VLOOKUP, XLOOKUP doesn't care about column order and won't break if columns move.*

Figure 2 — XLOOKUP pulls Gender and AgeGroup from Profiles, matched on UserID.

Why XLOOKUP, not copy-paste? A lookup matches each record by its key, so the right profile always lands on the right row even if the sheets are sorted differently. XLOOKUP is preferred over VLOOKUP because it doesn't depend on column position and won't break if columns are moved.

Step 4 — Flag cost level with IF

STAGE 3 · CLEAN / PREPARE

What you do: Add a **HighCost?** column:

```
=IF([@[SubscriptionCost (£)]] > 9, "High", "Standard")
```

Why a formula flag? A derived category lets you group and filter by cost band later without re-judging each row. Note the rule is *strictly greater than* £9, so a £9.00 plan is "Standard". In this data, 4 of the 20 records are "High".

Scenario 2 — Data Analysis

Step 5 — Total hours by platform (SUMIF)

STAGE 4 · ANALYSE

What you do: `=SUMIF(Stats[Platform], "Netflix", Stats[HoursWatched])` for each platform.

Why SUMIF? It totals only the rows matching one condition (the platform) — far more reliable than filtering and adding by hand. Mind the argument order: range, criterion, then the column to sum.

Step 6 — Average satisfaction by platform (AVERAGEIF)

STAGE 4 · ANALYSE

What you do: `=AVERAGEIF(Stats[Platform], "Netflix", Stats[SatisfactionScore])` .

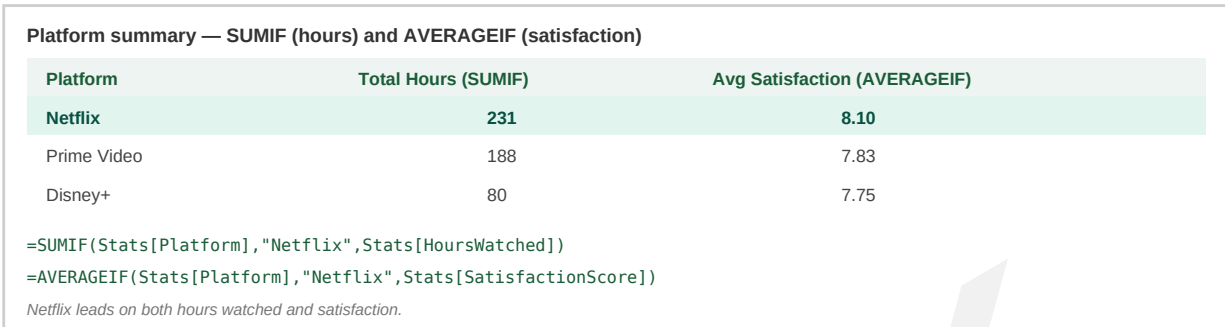


Figure 3 — Platform totals from SUMIF (hours) and AVERAGEIF (satisfaction).

Expected results:

Platform	Total Hours	Avg Satisfaction
Netflix	231	8.10
Prime Video	188	7.83
Disney+	80	7.75

Netflix leads on both hours watched and satisfaction.

Step 7 — Satisfaction by gender and platform (AVERAGEIFS)

STAGE 4 · ANALYSE

What you do: Use AVERAGEIFS for two-condition combinations:

`=AVERAGEIFS(Stats[SatisfactionScore], Stats[Gender], "Female", Stats[Platform], "Netflix")`

Watch the argument order: AVERAGEIFS puts the *average range first*, then each criteria pair — the reverse of AVERAGEIF. Mixing the two up is the most common error on this step.

Expected results (sample): Female+Netflix **8.38**, Male+Netflix **7.00**, Female+Disney+ **7.75**, Male+Prime Video **8.00**. Female Netflix viewers are the most satisfied group.

Step 8 — Pivot Table and Pivot Chart

STAGE 5 · VISUALISE

What you do: Insert a Pivot Table with AgeGroup as rows, Platform as columns, and **Average of HoursWatched** as values. Add a clustered column Pivot Chart titled "Average Viewing Hours by Age Group and Platform".

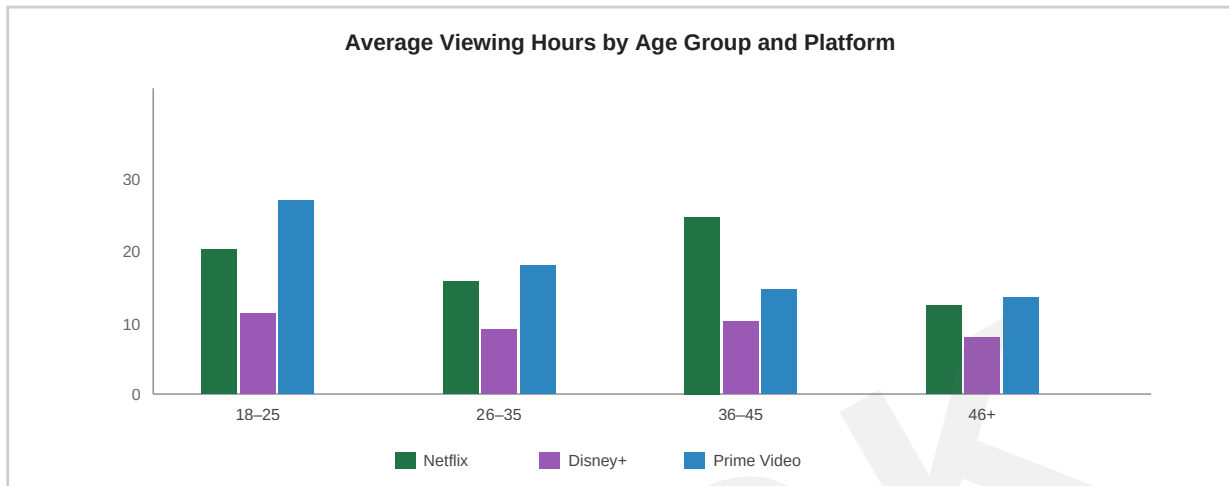


Figure 4 — Average viewing hours by age group and platform.

Why a Pivot Table here? It cross-tabulates two dimensions (age × platform) in one step, which would be laborious with individual formulas. The clustered chart then makes the age-and-platform patterns visible at a glance.

Step 9 — Summary table and conditional formatting

STAGE 5 · VISUALISE

What you do: Build a summary table of Platform, Total Hours, Average Satisfaction and Cost Level, and apply conditional formatting (colour scales or icons) so the strongest and weakest stand out.

Step 10 — Interpret and report

STAGE 6 · INTERPRET / REPORT

What you do: Write a short plain-English summary (3–5 sentences) for non-technical stakeholders.

On "does cost affect satisfaction?" Comparing the cost band against satisfaction, there is almost no relationship (the correlation is near zero, about 0.07) — a more expensive subscription does not buy higher satisfaction. That is itself a worthwhile finding to report.

"Netflix is the clear leader, with the most hours watched (231) and the highest average satisfaction (8.1). Disney+ trails on both. Cost has almost no bearing on satisfaction — the priciest plans don't score higher — so value, not price, drives satisfaction. Female Netflix viewers are the most satisfied group, and viewing hours are highest among younger and mid-range age groups."

Marker's checklist — process followed in order

- **Identify/Collect:** both CSVs imported, sheets named Profiles/Stats, workbook saved.
- **Clean/Prepare:** validated keys; blended Gender/AgeGroup with XLOOKUP; HighCost? flag by IF (>£9).
- **Analyse:** SUMIF hours; AVERAGEIF satisfaction; AVERAGEIFS by gender+platform (correct argument order).
- **Visualise:** Pivot Table (age × platform); clustered Pivot Chart; summary table with conditional formatting.
- **Interpret/Report:** plain-English write-up incl. the cost-vs-satisfaction finding.